

MUMBAI | Trial Run



Three months after the 26/11 terror attacks in Mumbai, the trial against Mohammed Ajmal Amir Kasab finally began on March 23. While special security arrangements are being made within the Arthur Road Jail, Special Judge M.L. Tahilyani has arranged to begin court proceedings without further ado. To save time and reduce the threat to Kasab's life, the judge is conducting the trial through video conferenc-

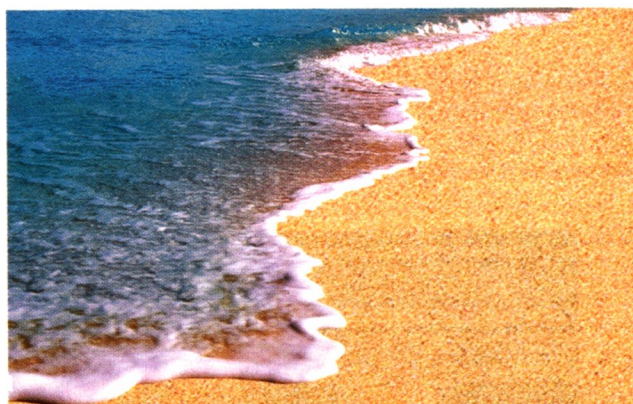
ing, a method that was used for the first time in the multi-crore stamp paper case involving Abdul Karim Telgi. It is likely that the trial will be completed within the next three to four months. Kasab has admitted that he is from Pakistan. While the next hearing comes up on March 30, the actual proceedings of the court, within the jail precincts, are likely to begin by April 13.

by Swati Mathur

BANGALORE | Statue Switch

After nearly a decade, it's time for Karnataka's statue exchange programme with Tamil Nadu to be implemented. No one really seems to remember that a statue of Tamil poet Tiruvalluvar was to be installed in Karnataka in exchange for Tamil Nadu putting up a statue of Kannada saint-poet Sarvagya. A veiled statue of Tiruvalluvar has been sitting near Ulsoor lake of Bangalore while Sarvagya is still being chiselled out of stone. The current governments in both states have now decided to end the exile of the two saint-poets by ensuring that the project is implemented before the general elections.

by Nirmala Ravindran



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